In the Wheat Fields

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In the Wheat Fields

by jumyouboshi

Summary

"...It still doesn't feel real, Mydei," he admits after a while, his voice quiet after working its way past the lump in his throat. "Is it…really okay for me to live alongside everyone like this?"

Understanding Phainon's subtle request, Mydei nods. "This is the dawn you fought so hard for, Deliverer. Why wouldn't you be allowed to partake in it? And if you have any doubts that this is real…"

Gently, he takes one of Phainon's wrists, then presses the palm to his chest, over his heart.

"Then let this heartbeat be proof of our shared existence."

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Phainon had grown accustomed to endless suffering and isolation, but Mydei always has a way of bringing him back into the light.

Notes

I needed a bit of closure after Amphoreus' ending, so I kind of wrote this for myself more than anything? I might delete this later once I've returned to my senses but we'll see (I'm sleep-deprived AGAIN)

There are some mild ending spoilers for 3.7 and the Exotale sidequest/dialogue but nothing too big. Also this isn't proofread at all so don't mind the mistakes.....

In the wheat fields of Aedes Elysiae, a lone figure gazes up into the heavens, the painted skies of dusk reflected in his blue eyes.

Around him, the evening breeze caresses his hair and skin, carrying with it the sweet scent of home. The crisp air is filled with the rhythmic rustling of wheat stalks. Everything is as Phainon remembers it, a scene so picturesque and idyllic that it almost seems like it's a dream.

He still fears that it is.

"So this is where you've scampered off to, Deliverer."

He tenses at the sound of the voice, then the other man's approach. Alongside his homeland, he *has* dreamed of his other half more times than he could count, but those dreams had been rife with blood, flames, and death—far removed from the scene he sees now, of the king, majestic and *alive,* wading through the wheat field towards him, the golden stalks parting for him as he walks.

Before such a magnificent sight, Phainon can barely bring himself to raise his head, let alone look Mydei in the eye. Instead, he casts a glance to the side, where the wheat fields seem to stretch for eternity. "Did you need something?" he asks.

"You've been avoiding the others since you were discharged from the Twilight Courtyard." *You've been avoiding me too,* goes unsaid, but Phainon can hear it in his voice, and he feels a twinge of guilt.

"...Sorry," Phainon says after taking a moment to find his voice again. "I've had a lot on my mind. I think I still need some more time before I can face everyone."

Mydei watches him thoughtfully, but doesn't press. He knows. *Everyone* knows, having regained their memories of 33 million past lives. And they have shown Phainon absolutely nothing but utmost care and love, in spite of it.

It's Phainon himself who can't bring himself to accept that love. Not yet. Not when he feels so undeserving of it.

Recognizing that Phainon isn't going to say anything else, Mydei speaks again. "Then make sure you go see them when you're ready. They will welcome you back with open arms, as they have been wanting to."

The swordsman feels a lump forming in his throat at that. How he's yearned for the days when he could return to the arms of his friends and comrades. How he's yearned for the endless pain to stop, for the loneliness to go away, for a life that could mend his broken heart. He had spent so long forging himself into a blade of hatred, only capable of furthering the will of Destruction, that he feels so disconnected from the peace and love that he's now all but promised—no matter how much he wants it.

“...Even after everything that I had to do?” Phainon can’t help but ask quietly, even though he fears the answer. “To you and everyone else?”

But Mydei’s gaze remains firm, unchanging. “Are you being deliberately obtuse? I would have thought that everyone’s actions so far have already portrayed the depths of their care for you. But I know how you are,” he adds with a light scoff. “A word of advice, Deliverer. If you truly wish to know about how the others feel about you, it’d be best to hear what they have to say from their own lips, rather than make assumptions. You’ll find yourself more welcome than you think.”

Phainon finally dares raise his head slowly, looking at Mydei with trepidation. “...How about you, Mydei?” he asks.

“I already told your first self. But perhaps you didn’t hear me, trapped by Irontomb and lost in the throes of suffering as you were, so allow me to reiterate.

“Even if I had to go through hundreds of billions of cycles again, I would still entrust my weakness to you. So let go of your regrets. You don’t need them anymore. And…” He pauses, before looking into his eyes and adding, “Know that for as long as this peaceful eternity lasts, I will not let you go. And when we are finally reborn into the new world… I will find you again, just as I did 33 million lifetimes over. That is my vow to you.

“There is no one more deserving of that love than you.”

The weight of Mydei’s devotion nearly cracks him open. His lip trembles, and his eyes sting, but he doesn’t cry. He still can’t. He’s been through far too much.

They all have.

But this happy dream is their reality now, just as Mydei’s searing gaze is, warm enough to melt away the cold isolation that had encased him for so long. And Phainon doesn’t want to be the one holding everyone back with the feelings he’s still unable to reconcile.

Perhaps…there’s no harm in placing his heart in Mydei’s hands one more time.

“...It still doesn’t feel real, Mydei,” he admits after a while, his voice quiet after working its way past the lump in his throat. “Is it…really okay for me to live alongside everyone like this?”

Understanding Phainon’s subtle request, Mydei nods. “This is the dawn you fought so hard for, Deliverer. Why wouldn’t you be allowed to partake in it? And if you have any doubts that this is real…”

Gently, he takes one of Phainon’s wrists, then presses the palm to his chest, over his heart.

“Then let this heartbeat be proof of our shared existence.”

For a while, Phainon can only stare. The heart thrumming beneath his fingertips feels strong, just as the warmth of Mydei’s skin and the gentle yet firm grip around his wrist quell his

doubts. *Mydei is alive.* All is as Phainon remembers from all the tender, intimate moments they have shared together, over millions and millions of cycles.

The swordsman lets out a small, shaky breath, and meekly raises his head again.

“Mydei… Can I come closer?”

Mydei doesn’t answer with words. Instead, he simply pulls Phainon against him, one arm around his waist, another around his back, and Phainon finally melts, throwing his own arms around Mydei’s neck and shoulders and holding him tight. Alongside the smile that he feels spreading across his face, the tears he thought he’d never be able to shed again prickle at the corners of his eyes, and for the first time since the Eternal Recurrences started, they don’t evaporate.

It’s a little while before Mydei and Phainon can bring themselves to pull away from each other. Even when they do, they are reluctant to completely part; Phainon’s arms remain wound around one of Mydei’s, while Mydei rests his head atop Phainon’s. Dusk has progressed into twilight, and the first stars are beginning to appear in the sky above them.

It’s Mydei who breaks the silence first. “So this is your homeland,” he muses.

“It’s beautiful, isn’t it? I always wished I could show you and the others what it looked like. Never in my wildest dreams did I ever think it’d actually be possible, even if we were able to save Amphoreus,” Phainon says.

“I can see now why you coveted it so. There isn’t a sight like this in any other part of the world.”

“Mm.”

He closes his eyes, relishing in the cool breeze, the sweet scent of wheat, the warmth of his lover. As he does, a faint image gradually forms in mind—one from one of his past lives. “...Being surrounded by the wheat stalks like this reminds me of one lifetime where I was able to live in Aedes Elysiae until the very moment the world ended. When I grew up, I learned a folk dance that all the adults did with their significant others at our festivals. But I never did find a partner during that lifetime, so I never shared a dance with anyone.”

“...Ha. So if we never met, you would have never taken a partner for yourself?” Mydei laughs through his nose. “Should I be flattered?”

“Don’t let that get to your head, Mydeimos. But…it’s true that no one can ever compare to you.”

He looks hopefully at Mydei then, and Mydei immediately understands. The king stands, then holds out a hand for Phainon to take, and the moment their fingers touch, he pulls Phainon onto his feet.

“Teach me the steps of your dance, Deliverer.”

Phainon smiles. Then, he shifts, intertwining his fingers with Mydei's, and his free hand is guided to his own waist. Their starting position established, Phainon allows himself a caress of Mydei's cheek, his angled jaw, his neck, before his palm settles on the firm muscles of the king's broad shoulders.

"Ready?" he whispers softly.

And Mydei nods, gazing at Phainon with tender eyes—the same eyes that Phainon would fall in love with in every life, the same eyes that he will fall in love with in every life from now on. "Always."

In the wheat fields of Aedes Elysiae, two figures join hands and lose themselves in a dance for two, with the stars of the true sky as their witness.

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